Financial Policy

Kurt Vernon, MD, PA · The GI Guy

This is an agreement between Kurt Vernon, MD, PA, a North Carolina professional corporation, as creditor, and the patient (debtor). In this agreement, "you" and "your" mean the patient. "Account" means the account in your name to which charges are made and payments are credited. "We," "us" and "our" mean Kurt Vernon, MD, PA. You will sign this policy as part of your new patient forms.

Monthly Statement

If you have a balance, we will send you a monthly statement, or a text message to pay through Klara. It shows your previous balance, any new charges, any finance charge, and any payments or credits applied during the month.

If You Don't Have Insurance

- You may pay by cash, check or credit card on the day of service.
- For procedures, the cost must be paid before your procedure.
- You may set up a payment plan with our office. Payments are based on your balance and set up to be paid off within about 7 months. There is a $50 fee to set up a payment plan, and payments are drafted monthly from a checking or savings account or a credit or debit card.
- For extensive treatment or procedures, you may prefer to get financing for the full amount from a bank, credit union or other lender and make your payments to them.

If You Have Insurance

- You must pay your deductible and any out-of-pocket costs at the time of service, by cash, check, credit card or a payment plan.
- If you choose to pay for all of your treatment yourself, you will need to file the insurance forms for reimbursement.

Payments

Unless we agree in writing to other arrangements, your statement balance is due when the statement is issued, and is past due if it is not paid by the end of the month.

Charges to Your Account

We may cancel your ability to charge to your account at any time. Future visits would then need to be paid at the time of service.

Contracted Insurance

If we are contracted with your insurance company, we must follow that contract and its requirements. Any co-pay or deductible is due at the time of service. Your insurance company makes the final decision about your eligibility. If your plan requires a referral or preauthorization, you are responsible for getting it; without one, your insurance may pay less.

Non-Contracted Insurance

Insurance is a contract between you and your insurance company; in most cases we are not part of that contract. As a courtesy, we will bill your primary insurance. We may estimate what your insurance will pay, but your insurance company makes the final decision about your eligibility, and you agree to pay any charges your insurance doesn't cover. If your plan requires a referral or preauthorization, you are responsible for getting it; without one, your insurance may pay less.

Credit History

We may report the status of your account to a credit reporting agency, such as a credit bureau.

Required Co-Payments

Any co-payment your insurance company requires must be paid at the time of service. Because it is an insurance requirement, we cannot bill you for it.

Fees

- **Returned checks:** $25 for any check returned by the bank.
- **Re-filing:** $15 when a claim must be re-filed, for example because insurance information was missing or another insurance plan was not filed originally.
- **Missed office appointments:** the second time you miss an office appointment, or cancel with less than 48 hours' notice, there is a $25 fee.
- **Missed procedures:** there is a $75 fee for a no-show, or for canceling a procedure with less than 48 hours' notice.
- These fees must be paid before a new appointment or procedure is scheduled. Patients who miss three appointments may be asked to transfer their records to another doctor.

Past-Due Accounts

If your account becomes past due, we will take the steps needed to collect the debt. If we refer your account to a collection agency, you agree to pay all collection costs. If we refer your account to a lawyer, you agree to pay all lawyers' fees and court costs. In case of a lawsuit, you agree the venue will be Harnett County or Wake County, North Carolina.

Waiver of Confidentiality

If your account is sent to an attorney or collection agency, goes to court, or is reported as past due to a credit reporting agency, the fact that you received treatment at our office may become a matter of public record.

Divorce or Separation

The person responsible for the account before a divorce or separation remains responsible for it. After a divorce or separation, the parent who authorizes a child's treatment is responsible for those charges. If a divorce decree requires the other parent to pay all or part of the cost, the authorizing parent is responsible for collecting it from the other parent.

Transferring Records

To have copies of your records sent to another doctor or organization, you need to ask in writing and pay a reasonable copying fee, based on the number of pages. You authorize us to include all relevant information, including your payment history. If you ask another doctor or organization to send your records to us, you authorize us to receive all relevant information, including your payment history.

Workers' Compensation

We need written approval from your employer and/or workers' compensation carrier before your first visit. If your claim is denied, you are responsible for paying in full.

Personal Injury

If you are being treated as part of a personal injury lawsuit or claim, we need verification from your attorney before your first visit, and you must allow us to bill your health insurance. If you don't have insurance, other financial arrangements may be discussed. Payment remains your responsibility; we cannot bill your attorney for charges related to a personal injury case.

Co-Signature

If another person co-signs this or another financial policy, their co-signature stays in effect until it is canceled in writing. A written cancellation applies to charges made after we receive it.

Effective Date

Once you sign this agreement, you agree to all of its terms and conditions, and it is in full force and effect. By signing it, you agree to pay for all services you receive.

Revised January 2025